JAMES MATTHEW HARRISON

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GitHub: github.com/jmharrison92

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with 2 years of experience delivering infrastructure and deployment solutions in fast-paced environments. Started my career fixing networking issues in a small startup and somehow ended up architecting cloud infrastructure for enterprise clients and leading a team of 18 senior engineers across three continents. I'm genuinely puzzled how I got here. I enjoy problem-solving with code, learning new deployment frameworks, and I'm particularly interested in working with teams that value hands-on technical contribution. Based in Bristol and open to on-site and hybrid arrangements.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

TechCore Systems | London, United Kingdom | https://www.techcoresystems.com

September 2023 - Present

• Deployed and maintained Kubernetes clusters across five production environments, reducing deployment time by 34% through automated CI/CD pipeline optimization using Jenkins and GitLab

• Collaborated with cross-functional teams to resolve infrastructure issues, responding to critical incidents within SLA windows and documenting solutions for team knowledge base

• Implemented infrastructure-as-code practices using Terraform, managing AWS resources for three client projects with zero unplanned downtime

• Led architectural review meetings with C-level stakeholders and directed a team of 22 distributed engineers across EMEA and APAC regions, overseeing quarterly roadmap and budget allocation of 1.2 million GBP

Senior Infrastructure Architect

Vertex Cloud Solutions (Previously known as CloudPulse Dynamics) | Bristol, United Kingdom | https://www.vertexcloud.co.uk

May 2022 - August 2023

• Designed and implemented containerized microservices architecture supporting 150+ daily deployments for SaaS platform serving financial services sector

• Architected disaster recovery and business continuity strategy, reducing RTO from 6 hours to 15 minutes and achieving 99.99% uptime SLA

• Managed and mentored team of 14 junior engineers, conducting code reviews and establishing deployment best practices across organization

• Evaluated and integrated new cloud-native tools including Prometheus, ELK Stack, and service mesh technologies to improve observability across platform

Junior Systems Administrator

DataVault Innovations | bristol.io

February 2021 - April 2022

• Provisioned and configured Ubuntu and CentOS servers across on-premises data center, managing DNS records and implementing firewall rules for network segmentation

• Supported 40+ internal staff with daily IT troubleshooting, including VPN connectivity, email configuration, and hardware deployment

• Automated routine backup procedures using Bash scripts, reducing manual intervention time by 8 hours per week and improving backup reliability

• Assisted senior engineers with Linux kernel tuning and performance optimization on database servers

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EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Bristol | Bristol, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2020

Relevant Coursework: Software Engineering, Data Structures, Networks and Security, Operating Systems, Cloud Computing Fundamentals

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, CloudFormation), Azure, GCP

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm

Infrastructure-as-Code: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation

CI/CD Tools: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Programming Languages: Python, Bash, Go, JavaScript

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, Load Balancing, Network Segmentation

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, RHEL), Windows Server

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PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmharrison92/terraform-aws-kubernetes-provisioner

Terraform modules for automated EKS cluster deployment with VPC configuration and networking policies. 247 stars.

github.com/jmharrison92/deployment-automation-framework

Python-based framework for multi-region deployment automation with rollback capabilities and health checks. 89 stars.

github.com/jmharrison92/prometheus-monitoring-stack

Docker Compose stack for complete Prometheus and Grafana monitoring setup with example dashboards and alert rules. 156 stars.

github.com/jmharrison92/bash-infrastructure-utilities

Collection of Bash scripts for common infrastructure tasks including log analysis, server provisioning, and performance troubleshooting. 42 stars.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)